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Submitter Information

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General Comment

From:
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I am a disabled small business owner who relies on illustration work done for private clients for my income. I consider myself extremely fortunate to have this option, and have worked hard for years to develop my skills as a creator in order to make best possible use of it. Even so, the financial reality for visual artists is a life that is tenuously stable at best. Generative AI is a threat to americans across all creative industries who have strived to hone their crafts as professionals, as an unethically sourced technology that can and will be used to destroy livelihoods as cost-cutting replacement for artistic labor.

Adding insult to injury, the forces behind visually generative AI want free reign to take and use the results of creative professionals' lifetimes of work in order to refine the machine being built to ruin their lives. They seek an unprecedented exception to copyright in a way that is transparently for their own personal gain in order to sustain a business model that they fear cannot survive under ethical conditions. If AI companies are unable to train their models via licensing and paying for source works, their business model is fundamentally a failure. It's not the government's place to prop up bad business plans predicated on stealing from hardworking professionals.

While I have criticisms regarding the sustainability of "AI" tech I recognize there are many fields in which it presents potential for important innovations. Visual arts is not one of them, and creating legal shortcuts for a barrier in development will not be of any boon to industries that may actually benefit from AI tech. If anything, the sources of AI training data should be heavily regulated now to encourage the development of a robust technology that can produce reliable results when faced with future barriers.

No copyright exemptions for big tech. Thank you for your time.